



December 11 2025

The Honorable Gavin Newsom
Governor of California
1021 O Street, Suite 9000
Sacramento, CA 95814

Re: Senate Bill 23 - Support

Dear Governor Newsom,

We, the California Teachers Association, are writing in support of Senate Bill 23, Business Tax Credits: Educational Donations.

Now more than ever, our education system is suffering from extensive underfunding and budget cuts, something which, if left unaltered, will irreparably harm our state. Senator Niello's bill works to help alleviate some of the burdens schools now face due to their lack of funding by incentivizing businesses to make donations to California's educational institutions. As stated in the bill's text, a qualified donation means a "contribution of money, books, computer equipment, or other tangible resources directly related to the educational mission of the institution receiving the donation," meaning that these donations will be directly available for the institutions to use to further improve the quality of education that they provide.

While this bill as a whole is already a great step in the right direction, there are some aspects that we, the California Teachers Association, feel could be amended to better ensure this bill has its intended effect. Firstly, we would like to see the bill amended to make it a requirement that for a donation to qualify, the recipient educational institution must sign off acknowledging that the donation was something useful for the institution. This amendment would help ensure that businesses do not abuse the new tax incentive by simply donating without ensuring that the items being donated are truly desired by the institution, as otherwise, the overall outcome of the donation would not be as impactful as the tax revenue itself. An additional amendment we recommend is one to prioritize the verification of donations to underfunded/rural/low-income educational institutions or, in some way, ensure that donations are conducted in an equitable manner in order to ensure that they do not inadvertently increase the funding disparity between institutions.

While there are aspects of SB 23 that the CTA feels could be improved upon, and it does not serve to target the root of the issue of California's education system not receiving the funding it so desperately needs, the bill is a valuable step in the right direction. Passage of this bill would not only directly help public schools and other educational institutions but would also show the Senate's strong dedication to supporting the education of all Californians.

For these reasons, we strongly urge you to support SB 23.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jack Klein". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Jack Anthony Klein (He/They) - Lobbyist
California Teachers Association